

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of California, Merced Assistant Professor	2024 - Present
Harvard University Academy Scholar, The Harvard Academy for International and Area Studies	2023-2025
Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM) and Innovations for Poverty Action, Mexico Predoctoral Fellow	2022-2023
Center for U.S.-Mexican Studies Visiting Fellow	2021-2022

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego Ph.D in Political Science <i>Fields:</i> Comparative Politics, Methodology	2017 – 2023
University of California, San Diego , M.A. Political Science	2019
El Colegio de México , Summer Program on Mexican Political Institutions	2017
George Mason University , M.A. International Security	2017
Southwestern University , B.A. Political Science and Spanish	2014

RESEARCH

Book Project

- *Criminal Conglomerates: How Drug Cartels Diversify and Capture the State in Latin America*
– Expected submission: October 2026.

Articles

- [7] Fernanda Quintanilla Domínguez and Marco Alcocer. 2026. “Queenpins: Women Leaders and Violence in Organized Crime” *Accepted at Comparative Political Studies*.
- [6] Alcocer, Marco and Megan Erickson. 2026. “[The Transformation of Mexican Cartels and Violence Against State Officials](#)” *Journal of Peace Research*: 00(0), 1-16.
- [5] Alcocer, Marco. 2026. “[Criminal Conflicts and the Killing of Law Enforcement Officers in Mexico](#)”, *Journal of Conflict Resolution*: 70(5), 870–895.
- [4] Alcocer, Marco. Skillman, Rachel. Beltran-Torres, Angie. 2026. “[Female Mayors and Violence Against Women: Evidence from Mexico](#)”, *Political Science Research and Methods*: 14(3): 1032–39. doi:10.1017/psrm.2025.10030.
- [3] Alcocer, Marco. 2025. “[Increasing Intergovernmental Coordination to Fight Crime: Evidence from a Police Reform in Mexico](#)”, *Political Science Research and Methods*: 13(3): 745–54. doi: 10.1017/psrm.2024.31.
- [2] Alcocer, Marco. Falabella, Leonardo. Lange, Alex. Smith, Nicholas. Feeley, Maureen. 2024. “[Supplemental online resources improve data literacy education: Evidence from a social science methods course](#)”, *PLOS ONE* 19(12): 1–16, .
- [1] Alcocer, Marco. 2023. “[Integrating Potential Outcomes and Causal Mechanisms to Guide Multi-Method Research](#)” *Qualitative & Multi-Method Research*, 21(2). doi: 10.5281/zenodo.8418913.

Working Papers

- [5] “Border Externalization and Migrant Welfare in Transit” (with Elena Barham) *Revised and Re-submitted at PNAS*.
- [4] “Border Externalization and Violence Along Migration Routes: Evidence from Remain in Mexico” (with Elena Barham) *Under Review*.
- [3] “Criminal Fragmentation: The Logic of Splintering in Organized Crime” (with Lucía Hesles Toscana) *Under Review*.
- [2] “Disguised Vigilantes: Civilian Uprisings and Strategic Fragmentation in Organized Crime” (with Renatta Salinas Delgado and Megan Erickson) *Under Review*.
- [1] “Drug Wars, Organized Crime Expansion, and State Capture: Evidence from Mexico”

Works in Progress

- [3] Music, Organized Crime, and Government Censorship: The Case of *Narcocorridos* in Mexico (with Isabel Laterzo-Tingley) *Experiment fielded*.
- [2] “Politician Responsiveness Amidst Human Rights Crises: The Case of Disappearances in Mexico (with Hyunju Lee) *Experiment fielded*.
- [1] “Assessing the Impact of Learning Assistants in Social Science Methods Courses (with Lindsay Crawford) *Experiment in field Spring and Fall semesters 2026*.

PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

- Expert interview. [Mexico: War of the drug cartels](#). DW Documentary.
- Op-ed. [¿Las mujeres políticas reducen la violencia contra las mujeres?](#) Nexos.
- Expert interview. [Fentanyl Network “El Mencho”](#). Do Rzeczy.
- Podcast. [Episode 10: Looking Across the Southern Border - Drug Wars and Politics in Mexico](#). World Discord Podcast.

DATA PROJECTS

[Mapping Criminal Organizations \(MCO\)](#) (with Patrick Signoret, Fernanda Sobrino, Cecilia Farfan)

- Co-Founder and Lead Investigator
- *Supported by the Center for U.S.–Mexican Studies at UCSD, the Empirical Studies of Conflict Project, and the Data-Driven Social Science Initiative at Princeton University.*

Original Data

- Signoret, Patrick; Marco Alcocer; Cecilia Farfan-Mendez; Fernanda Sobrino, 2021, “Mapping Criminal Organizations in Mexico: State Panel 2007-2015”, <https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/N0KGCZ>, Harvard Dataverse, V1.
 - In the media: [El Financiero](#), [Mexico Today \(by Reforma\)](#), [IMER Noticias](#), [Al Calor Politico](#), [Cuestione](#)
- Alcocer, Marco, 2024, “Mapping Criminal Organizations in Guanajuato”, <https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/WJSGWW>, Harvard Dataverse, V1.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND INVITED TALKS

Harvard University	2025
Latin American Studies Association (LASA)	2024, 2025, 2026
Southern Political Science Association (SPSA)	2026
Building Democratic Resilience: Institutions and Attitudes in Latin America, UT Austin	2026
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	2021, 2022, 2024, 2025
Organized Crime and Drug Trafficking Seminar, UNAM	Spring 2024
Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Harvard University	Spring 2024
David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies, Harvard University	Spring 2024
The Center for Inter-American Policy and Research (CIPR), Tulane University	Spring 2024
Southwestern University	Spring 2024

Emerging Methodologists Workshop for Qualitative and Multi-Method Explanatory Research	2023
American Political Science Association (APSA)	2019, 2020, 2023
Public Choice Society	2023
ITAM	Fall 2022
Englehart Research Forum, Bowling Green State University	Fall 2022
Illicit Economies and Extra-Legal Actors Conference, Center for U.S.-Mexican Studies	2022
Latin American Peace Science Society (LAPSS)	2022
Southwest Workshop on Mixed-Methods Research (SWMMR)	2021
Seminario para la Política de Drogas en América Latina, U. de los Andes and CIDE	2018
XXXV Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology (Polmeth XXXV)	2018
11 th Annual Political Networks Conference and Workshop (Polnet)	2018

PROFESSIONAL AND METHODOLOGICAL TRAINING

Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR)	2021
ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research	2018
Combating Transnational Organized Crime in the Americas	2016
• <i>National Defense University, William J. Perry Center for Hemispheric Studies</i>	

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Howard Hughes Medical Institute (HHMI) Success in Science Award through UC Merced	2026
Emerging Methodologists, Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (QMMR)	2023
Student Fellow, Public Choice Society	2023
NSF/APSA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant (DDRIG), \$9,580	2021-2022
Course Development and Instructional Improvement Program (CDIIP), <i>UCSD</i> , \$25,000	2020
• with Leonardo Falabella, Alex Lange, and Nicholas Smith	
Friends Fellowship, <i>Friends of the International Center, UCSD</i>	2019
Predocutorial Fellowship (Honorable Mention), <i>Ford Foundation</i>	2019
Field Research Grant, <i>Tinker Foundation and CILAS</i>	Summer 2018
John A. Garcia ICPSR Scholarship, <i>Society for Political Methodology</i>	2018
Minority Fellowship Award, <i>American Political Science Association</i>	Spring 2018
Paul W. Drake Research Grant, <i>UCSD Political Science Department</i>	2018
Dean's Fellowship Merit Scholarship, <i>George Mason University</i>	2015-2016
HSF Scholar, <i>Hispanic Scholarship Fund</i>	2016

TEACHING

[Foundations of Quantitative Research in Political Science](#) (APSA Educate online learning resource)

- with Leonardo Falabella, Alexandra Lange, and Nick Smith
- Supported by UCSD's Office of the Executive Vice Chancellor (CDIIP Grant)

UC Merced

Instructor of Record

- The Politics of Violence (PhD Level) 2025, 2026
- Comparative Political Institutions (PhD Level) 2024
- Political Violence 2025, 2026
- Understanding Political Controversies (Quant research design) 2024, Spring/Fall 2026

UCSD

Teaching Assistant - Discussion Section Leader

- Political Inquiry (Research design/Intro to statistics) 2018, 2020, 2022
- Analyzing Current Security Problems 2020

Teaching Assistant

- International Politics and Security, *School of Global Policy and Strategy* (Master's Level) 2021
- Policy Making Processes, *School of Global Policy and Strategy* (Master's Level) 2019

• International Human Rights Law: Rights of Migrants	2022
• Corruption in Developing Countries	2021
• American Political Parties	2021
• Religion and Politics	2020
• Latin American Politics	2019
• Weapons of Mass Destruction	2019
• Comparative Politics of Latin America	2018
• US & Latin America: Political and Economic Relations	2018
• Race and Ethnicity in American Politics	2017

ADVISING

Undergraduate

Lucía Hesles Toscano (ITAM)

Fernanda Quintanilla Domínguez (Tec de Monterrey, now predoc at DevLab@UPenn)

Renatta Salinas Delgado (Tec de Monterrey)

Graduate

Hyunju Lee (UC Merced - Dissertation Committee Member)

Chika Kenneth (UC Merced - Dissertation Committee Member)

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

Agustina Paglayan and Francisco Garfias, <i>UCSD</i>	2019-2020
Enrique Desmond Arias, <i>Baruch College, CUNY</i>	Fall 2016, Fall 2019
Justice in Mexico, <i>University of San Diego</i>	2018
Center for Security Policy Studies, <i>Schar School of Government and Policy</i>	2016-2017
Office of National Drug Control Policy, <i>Executive Office of the President</i>	2016

SERVICE

Pi Sigma Alpha - Faculty Advisor, UC Merced	2025-present
President, Graduate Student Council, UCSD Political Science Department	2018-2022
Mentor, Political Science Grad Pals Mentorship Program	2020-2023
Mentor, UCSD Graduate Student Affairs Grad Pals Program	2020-2021
Reviewer: <i>Journal of Politics, International Organization, Comparative Political Studies, Perspectives on Politics, Journal of Illicit Economies and Development, Studies in Comparative International Development, Plos One, Latin American Research Review, Revista INTER DISCIPLINA (CEIICH-UNAM), Política y Gobierno, Mexican Studies/Estudios Mexicanos, Governance, Criminal Justice Review, Comparative Politics, Global Crime</i>	

LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

Computer Languages	R, Stata, QGIS, ArcGis (intermediate), Python (intermediate), L ^A T _E X
Language	English (native), Español (native)